
Seoul's 12 Sunset Spots The 45 Minutes Before Sunset A Golden-Hour Guide

****Subtitle****

A different hour of Seoul than night view (#224)
12 golden-hour spots you can only catch by arriving 45 minutes before

Why Sunset Gets Its Own Guide — a Different Angle from the Night-View Guide

Seoul content has already covered night view a lot (#002 Free Night Views · #224 Night View Full Guide). But **sunset is a completely different game from night view**.

Category	Sunset (this guide)	Night View (#224)
Golden window	45 min before sunset to 20 min after — just 1 hour a day	after sunset to late night, plenty of time
Direction	Only spots with an open western sky work	direction doesn't matter, light density is what counts
Failure mode	Arrive late = the day is over. No retry until tomorrow	almost none
Best season	Sep–Nov (less fine dust · cool evening air)	year-round

In a travel itinerary, sunset is free content that fits exactly into the "one hour before dinner" slot. All 12 spots in this guide are **free to enter**, chosen for public-transit access.

① 3 Mistakes Foreigners Often Make

1. Timing Your Arrival to the Sunset "Moment"

The peak of a sunset isn't the official sunset time — it's **15–30 minutes before sunset** (the window when the sky spreads from orange to pink). If you arrive at sunset time, it's already over. **Arriving 45 minutes early is the formula.**

2. Chasing Height Without Checking Direction

Namsan Tower (남산타워) is tall, but buildings overlap the western view. A sunset isn't decided by height — it's decided by **how open the western horizon is**. That's why the top picks in this guide cluster along the western Han River and west-facing hills.

3. Watching the Sunset and Heading Straight Back Down

Half of these sunset spots **transform into night-view spots 20 minutes later**. Eungbongsan (응봉산, #051) and Maebongsan (매봉산) are the prime examples — watching sunset flow straight into night view from the same spot is the most efficient route.

② The Pick-by-Type Matrix — Where to Go Today

Type	Recommended Spots	Walking	Good to Go With
Han River water reflection	Seonyudo Park · Nodeul Island · Banpo Hangang Park	almost none	couples · families
Hillside panorama	Haneul Park · Eungbongsan · Maebongsan · Yongyangbongjeojeong Park	15–25 min of stairs	solo photographers
Fortress wall + skyline silhouette	Inwangsan Beombawi · Naksan Park · Bugak Pavilion	30–50 min hike	active groups
After-work value	Yeouido Mulbit Square · Mangwon Hangang Park	~10 min walk from the station	travelers on a tight schedule

③ The 12 Spots in Detail

Han River Water-Reflection Type

- 1. Seonyudo Park (선유도공원)** — An island park in the middle of the Yanghwa (양화) stretch of the Han River. The sun setting between the old water-treatment plant's structures makes the most "un-Seoul-like" picture in this guide. 10-min walk from Seonyudo Station (선유도역), Line 9. (Western Han River detail: #305)
- 2. Nodeul Island (노들섬)** — A culture island on the Hangang Bridge (한강대교). The best day is one where a sunset toward Yeouido (여의도) from the western lawn overlaps with a weekend-evening live performance. 10-min walk from Nodeul Station (노들역), Line 9.
- 3. Banpo Hangang Park (반포 한강공원)** — The sun sets behind Some Sevit (세빛섬). Once sunset ends, it flows naturally into the Moonlight Rainbow Fountain (달빛무지개분수) (Apr–Oct). 15-min walk from Express Bus Terminal Station (고속터미널역).
- 4. Mangwon Hangang Park (망원 한강공원)** — The most local-heavy sunset. A shrine to the convenience store (편의점, Korea's ubiquitous 24-hour corner store) instant-noodles-plus-picnic-mat combo. 12-min walk from Mangwon Station (망원역). (Han River culture full guide: #209–#700)

Hillside Panorama Type

- 5. Haneul Park (하늘공원)** — A silver-grass hill inside World Cup Park (월드컵공원). The combination of **October silver-grass season + sunset ranks #1 in all of Seoul**. 291 steps, or the Maengkkongi electric car (맹공이차, paid). 20+ min walk from World Cup Stadium Station (월드컵경기장역).
- 6. Eungbongsan Pavilion (응봉산 팔각정)** — The only steep hill that looks west over the eastern Han River. The sunset-to-night-view transition (#051) is the most dramatic here. 15-min stair walk from Eungbong Station (응봉역).
- 7. Maebongsan Pavilion (매봉산 팔각정)** — A hidden hill behind Hannam (한남) and Beotigogae (버티고개). A composition that frames Namsan Tower (남산타워) and the Han River together while catching the western sunset. 15-min walk from Beotigogae Station (버티고개역). Almost no tourists.
- 8. Yongyangbongjeojeong Park (용양봉저정공원)** — From a hill in Noryangjin (노량진), the sun sets beyond the Hangang Railroad Bridge (한강철교) and the Yeouido skyline. 15-min walk from Nodeul Station or Noryangjin Station (노량진역). A local evening-stroll course.

Fortress Wall + Skyline Silhouette Type

9. Inwangsan Beombawi (인왕산 범바위) — A rock lookout partway up the fortress-wall trail. The sun sets to the west as you look down over the Gyeongbokgung (경복궁)-Gwanghwamun (광화문) axis — the only composition that captures downtown and sunset together. 40-min hike from Dongnimmun Station (독립문역). (Hiking basics: #148)

10. Naksan Park (낙산공원) — A hill above Dongdaemun (동대문). The downtown silhouette beyond the fortress wall sinks into backlight. 15-min walk from Hyehwa Station (혜화역) — a great-value course for **fortress-wall sunset without the hike**.

11. Bugak Pavilion (북악 팔각정) — A lookout reachable by car or taxi. An alternative for groups who struggle to walk (family-senior companions). A full view of Seoul plus sunset from the city's north side.

After-Work Value Type

12. Yeouido Mulbit Square (여의도 물빛광장) — Right in front of Yeouinaru Station (여의나루역). #1 for accessibility among all 12 spots. Watching it mixed in with the after-work crowd (퇴근길, the homeward commute from Korea's financial district) is Seoul's weekday evening itself.

④ Monthly Sunset Times — an Arrival-Time Calculator

Month	Sunset (Seoul, approx.)	Recommended arrival (45 min before)
Sep	18:40–18:10 (6:40–6:10 PM)	17:30–17:55 (5:30–5:55 PM)
Oct	18:10–17:30 (6:10–5:30 PM)	17:15–16:50 (5:15–4:50 PM)
Nov	17:30–17:15 (5:30–5:15 PM)	16:45–16:30 (4:45–4:30 PM)
Dec–Jan	17:15–17:40 (5:15–5:40 PM)	16:30–17:00 (4:30–5:00 PM)
Apr–May	19:00–19:30 (7:00–7:30 PM)	18:15–18:45 (6:15–6:45 PM)
Jun–Aug	19:40–19:20 (7:40–7:20 PM)	around 19:00 (7:00 PM)

- For the exact time on the day, use the "sunset" value in your phone's weather app. The table above is an approximate figure for planning.
- **On bad fine-dust days, the sunset turns muddy** — picking a day marked "good" or "moderate" in an air-quality app is half the battle.

⑤ Field Tips

- **Lighting for the way down:** The stairs at Eungbongsan, Inwangsan, and Maebongsan go dark after sunset. Your phone light is enough, but flip-flops are a hard no.
- **Tripod:** The hillside pavilions have railings, so a mini tripod is plenty. For the Han River type, a low angle from a picnic mat actually works better.
- **Food route:** Mangwon (망원 → Mangwon Market (망원시장) food) · Eungbongsan (응봉산 → Seongsu (성수) dinner) · Naksan (낙산 → Daehangno (대학로)) — these 3 spots, with a dinner neighborhood right

next door after sunset, are the most efficient for first-timers.

- All of them are **free**. The only things that cost money are the Haneul Park Maengkkongi car and your dinner.

Keep Reading

- Seoul after dark → **#224 Night View Full Guide** · **#002 Top 10 Free Night Views**
- From sunset spot straight into night view → **#051 Eungbongsan Pavilion**
- A full day on the Han River → **#209 Summer Han River Master** · **#700 The Han River's 11 Parks**
- Western Han River park detail → **#305 Western Han River Park Guide**

Verification Notes (Pre-Publish Check)

- **Signal basis:** An MG-saved clip (eateat.mag, 24 sunset spots, 3,747 likes · 2026-08-13) was used only as a demand signal. The spot list itself wasn't drawn from the clip (text-in-image, nationwide scope) — it was **built independently on a Seoul axis**. Every spot is a public landmark (park-lookout), so there is no name-exposure risk.
- **Fact anchor:** all spots free to enter / Haneul Park's 291 steps·Maengkkongi car are paid / the Banpo Moonlight Rainbow Fountain runs Apr–Oct / the sunset-time table is an approximate figure based on Seoul's latitude, and the body text states plainly it's "for planning."
- **Creative boundary:** no specific restaurant-cafe names. Sunset times are given as a range, not a fixed value, with the reader directed to check the app on the day. Coverage check: zero prior pieces on the sunset axis (checked against contents.json, 2026-08-19).

Tags

#SeoulSunset #GoldenHour #HangangSunset #HaneulPark #Eungbongsan #SunsetSpots
#KeyChinGu